Gilded Affection

2025, An Art Nouveau-inspired illustration for a promotional poster

Context

Inspired by the work of Alphonse Mucha and the romantic symbolism of Art Nouveau, *Gilded Affection* brings together mythology, nature and the idea of timeless love. I chose Cupid, the Roman God of Love, as my theme, drawing from Mucha's frequent use of mythological and ethereal female figures. The illustration imagines Cupid as an angelic woman, surrounded by flowers that symbolise tenderness, affection and sincere emotion. Created for a fictional Valentine's Day musical, it aims to bring the charm of old-fashioned romance to a contemporary audience.

My role

Research, concept development, illustration and visual composition.

Process

I studied Mucha's illustrations, particularly his use of flowing linework, organic forms, florals and balanced compositions. I translated these elements into my own illustration of a female Cupid, using a heart-tipped bow, delicate wings and a flowing gown. I also explored floral symbolism, incorporating forget-me-nots and hydrangeas to reinforce the theme of affection. A soft pastel palette helped create the romantic, ornamental quality associated with Art Nouveau.

Outcome

An illustrated promotional poster concept for a fictional Valentine's Day musical, combining Art Nouveau influences with the symbolism of Cupid and flowers. It shows that I can study historical art styles through illustration and develop a visual language that communicates a theme through composition, colour and symbolism.





